

JAKARTA

Written by

Lorenzo Besana

INT. SHERWOOD RESIDENCE - DAY

It's Thanksgiving.

Six people sit at the groaning table.

MUM and POPS sit at opposite ends of the table.

Mum sits next to RACHEL (20's), her daughter, and CHRISTINA (30's), the girlfriend of JAMES (30's), her eldest son, who is seated next to pops and in front of our protagonist, MICHAEL (20's).

Everybody is chitchatting- but Michael is out of it.

He wiggles the little turkey left in the plate with his knife.

POPS

I'm telling ya. We are gonna do it.

JAMES

You say that every year.

MUM

You do say it every year, honey.
It's true.

RACHEL

It's gonna be OKC again. Everyone
knows it.

JAMES

What do you even know?

RACHEL

Everybody knows it.

JAMES

You don't know shit.

MUM

Language.

POPS

Come on, Jim. You are not seventeen
anymore.

Rachel sticks out her tongue at James, James makes a face in return.

CHRISTINA

Micheal are you ok?

Micheal scratches his head, still looking at his plate.

MICHAEL

Yeah. I just feel- I don't know.

Micheal brings his eyes to Christina, only to find **A WOMAN standing behind her, looking right at him.**

The woman is beautiful. She has short blond curly hair, deep emerald eyes and she is wearing this festive checkered blue and white dress. Most of all, she is pleasantly smiling. Not grinning or laughing, she is smiling as if she were genuinely happy to see Micheal.

Micheal turns to his mum, realizing she is also staring at him, void of emotions.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Mum?

Pops lays a hand on Micheal's shoulder. Micheal shivers.

POPS

What's wrong, son?

Micheal bolts away from the table, noticing his all family is blankly staring at him.

Micheal looks back at the woman, she hasn't moved an inch of her body.

MICHAEL

Who are you?

The woman tilts her head, her smile mutating to convey bemusement.

Micheal surveys the table before quickly grabbing the knife he was toying with a moment ago.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Who are all of you?

The woman reassumes her original stance.

Micheal points the knife at her.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Who are you?

She doesn't move.

He gestures with the knife towards her.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
I said who the fuck are you?!

She chuckles.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
(screaming)
I SAID WHO THE FUCK ARE YOU?

TRAIN RUMBLE starts to build up.

The woman drops her smile in a split second.

WOMAN
Wake up.

INT. TRAIN - DAY

A ticket inspector stands in front of a crumpled and confused Micheal.

INSPECTOR
Sir? I'm going to need to see a
ticket.

MICHAEL
What?

INSPECTOR
A ticket for this ride.

MICHAEL
I don't understand.

He looks out the window to the fleeting old brick factories
and warehouses.

MAN (O.C.)
It's next to his feet.

Micheal turns to the man sitting in front of him who is
pointing at his shoes.

Michael looks down to find a ticket for the Philadelphia to
Boston train ride with the name MICHEAL SHERWOOD on it.

Almost robotically, Micheal picks up the ticket and hands it
to the inspector who punches it and gives it back.

INSPECTOR
Have a good day, Mr. Sherwood.

The inspector leaves.

Micheal closes his eyes real tight, memories coming back.
He looks at his phone: it says 9.15.

MICHAEL
Jesus.

MAN #1
Is Lord.

The rumble of the train grows again.

The factories outside leave place to marshland and tidal inlets.

Micheal stares out the window, brows arching.

INT. BOSTON GRAND CENTRAL - LATER

Michael walks out the terminal with his carry-on by his side, still looking a bit worn-out.

He scouts the crowd for a moment, then, across the hall he sees SADIE MILLER (20's).

Sadie waves at him, Micheal heads towards her.

As they almost close in on each other, a MAN IN A BLACK SUIT AND FEDORA HAT strides between them.

Sadie and Micheal share a friendly hug.

SADIE
You look like shit.

MICHAEL
It's nice to see you too, Sadie.

SADIE
As always.

He forces an ironic smile, then gestures to the exit.

MICHAEL
Shall we?

SADIE
Yes, we shall.

INT. DINER - LATER

Sadie and Micheal sit across from each other.

Sadie studies him, intrigued by the way he scratches his eyes.

WAITRESS (O.C.)
What can I get you?

They both snap out of it.

MICHAEL
Yes. Hi.

WAITRESS
Hi.

SADIE
Hi.

MICHAEL
I'll have a coffee and she'll have
p-

SADIE
I'll have an egg and cheese
sandwich and a tall glass of OJ,
thank you very much.

WAITRESS
I'll be right back.

The waitress leaves.

Micheal arches his eyebrows at Sadie, inquisitive.

SADIE
What?

MICHAEL
Egg and cheese sandwich?

SADIE
Yes?

MICHAEL
Since when?

SADIE
What were you going to get me?

MICHAEL
Pancakes? As always?

SADIE
That was a long time ago.

MICHAEL
Not that long.

She looks down at the table.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
What?

SADIE
Nothing.

MICHAEL
You sure?

Silence falls on the table for a moment.

SADIE
Micheal-

The waitress comes back with their order.

WAITRESS
There you go. Enjoy your breakfast.

SADIE
Thank you very much.

Micheal immediately takes a sip from his coffee.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Did I already tell you that you
look like shit?

MICHAEL
Yes. Yes you did.

SADIE
Why is that?

MICHAEL
Didn't get that much sleep last
night.

SADIE
That I figured when you texted me
at 3.30 in the morning asking if I
could pick you up this morning.
Mike
(a beat)
What are you doing here? What are
you writing about?

MICHAEL
I'm not following a story. I'm here
to see you.

SADIE
Is that so?

MICHAEL
Yes. It is.

SADIE
And why would you want to see me?

MICHAEL
Why would I-

Micheal scoffs.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Because I miss you, Sadie.

SADIE
I'm sure you missed me when you
were drunk at 3.30 last night. Do
you still miss me now?

MICHAEL
Why are you- I wasn't drunk.

SADIE
Sure you weren't.

MICHAEL
I'm not lying to you.

SADIE
Micheal- I am not having this
conversation with you.

MICHAEL
What conversation?

SADIE
Let me finish.
(a beat)
It's nice to see you, it really is,
but we haven't seen- or talked to
each other for that matter- even
once in the past year. You didn't
even wish me a happy birthday-

MICHAEL
You didn't either.

She smiles.

SADIE

Of course. And I'm sorry about that, but what I was saying is- time has passed Mike, and if the true and sole reason you are here is that you missed me, then you missed me too late and I'm sorry you came all this way.

MICHAEL

Do you not miss me?

SADIE

Micheal.

Micheal looks out the window, bites his lower lip, then turns to Sadie.

MICHAEL

Why did you come to pick me up?

SADIE

Because I know there is no universe where you wouldn't do the same for me.

Michael smiles. She takes another bite of her sandwich and taps on his phone.

MICHAEL

That has to count for something.

11.32.

She drops the sandwich and BOLTS up.

SADIE

(mouth full)

I got to go.

MICHAEL

Wait- where?

SADIE

(putting on her jacket,
mumbled)

Rehearsal.

MICHAEL

What?

She swallows the bite.

SADIE
Rehearsal.

MICHAEL
For what?

SADIE
Mean Girls. The Musical. I'm
playing Cady.

MICHAEL
Aren't you a bit too-

SADIE
I'm sorry?

MICHAEL
I meant- I thought you were done
with theater.

SADIE
I told you already: it's been a
long time.

She smiles and leans into him to give him a kiss on the
cheek. Micheal shakes his head.

She heads heads for the exit.

He turns to her.

MICHAEL
I'll be at Paddy's tonight!

SADIE
(without turning)
I know!

EXT. THE GRAPE HOTEL - LATER

Michael walks up to the entrance of the "THE GRAPE HOTEL", a
mid-tier business hotel in downtown Boston, characterized by
a giant purple grape hanging above its sign.

Micheal pushes the revolving doors and enters.

INT. THE GRAPE HOTEL - CONTINUOUS

Micheal walks across the busy lobby. He reaches the
receptionist desk.

MICHAEL
Hi.

RECEPTIONIST
Good morning sir, how can I help
you?

MICHAEL
I have a reservation under
Sherwood, Micheal.

RECEPTIONIST
Sure thing, let me take a look real
quick.

The receptionist quickly types into her computer and presses
enter.

She frowns.

RECEPTIONIST (CONT'D)
Mh.

MICHAEL
Is everything okay?

RECEPTIONIST
Sherwood as in S-H-E-R-W-O-O-D? Is
that correct sir?

MICHAEL
Yes?

RECEPTIONIST
Did you maybe book through the
corporate portal?

MICHAEL
Maybe?

RECEPTIONIST
What's your place of employment,
sir?

MICHAEL
The Philly Daily.

RECEPTIONIST
Oh. A journalist.

MICHAEL
So they say.

She brings her eyes back to the computer and quickly types
again. She enters, then tilts her head.

She looks back up at Micheal.

RECEPTIONIST

Did you receive a confirmation email regarding your booking at The Grape Hotel?

MICHAEL

I think I did.

RECEPTIONIST

Could you pull that up for me, sir?

MICHAEL

I am one-hundred percent the room has been paid for already.

RECEPTIONIST

Sir, I'm sure it's just a server incongruence. Can I see the email confirmation?

Micheal forces a smile.

MICHAEL

Of course.

Micheal goes to his phone and quickly finds the email. He smugly turns the phone to the receptionist.

The receptionist smiles looking at the email.

RECEPTIONIST

Sir. Your reserved the "Early White Harvest" room from the 27th to the 29th of January.

MICHAEL

There you go.

The receptionist pulls down on Michael's phone with her index and turns it to him.

It's January 26th.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Today is not the 27th.

RECEPTIONIST

I'm afraid not.

MICHAEL

Shit. Sorry. It's the room available for tonight by any chance?

RECEPTIONIST

I'm afraid not, but we do have some limited availability in other accommodations.

MICHAEL

What's available?

RECEPTIONIST

We have one of our stunning "Chianti 2019" rooms still available. It is a bit more on the pricier side.

MICHAEL

Was 2019 a good harvest for Chianti?

RECEPTIONIST

A magnificent one.

MICHAEL

I see. Will you give me a second? I'll be right back.

RECEPTIONIST

And I'll be right here.

Micheal smiles, excuses himself.

LOBBY

Micheal pushes his luggage into the lobby and sinks into a chair.

He picks up his phone and calls someone.

INT. THEATER - SAME TIME

We see a phone with the caller ID "Micheal Sherwood" vibrating on a bench, as we hear the "Meet The Plastics" number being rehearsed in the background.

Micheal has the phone to his ear.

MICHAEL

(under his breath)

Pick up. Please.

SADIE (VOICEMAIL)

Sadie here! I'm really sorry I can't pick right now- but leave a message after the beep and I'll get back to you as soon as I can.

BEEP.

Micheal hangs up. We see he has her contact saved as "Sadie".

MICHAEL

Fuck me.

Micheal closes his eyes and lets his back hit the chair.

WOMAN (O.C.)

Everything okay?

Micheal hadn't even noticed her.

He turns to the woman.

MICHAEL

I'm sorry?

The woman (30's) is wearing an elegant dark green suit and keeps her red hair in a tight ponytail.

WOMAN

(slightly overlapping
with Christina's voice
from scene #1)

Are you okay?

MICHAEL

Oh- Yeah- I just f- messed up my reservation. Mixed up the days.

WOMAN

I see. I hate when that happens.

MICHAEL

Yeah. You staying here as well?

WOMAN

I've been here a couple of days actually, I was supposed to leave today but flight got canceled. At least they still had one of those "Chianti 2019" rooms available.

MICHAEL

Are they-

She looks at her watch.

WOMAN

Shoot. I'm going to be late, but see you around, okay?

MICHAEL
Of course.

She extends her hand towards Micheal.

Micheal stands up and shakes her hand.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Micheal.

NATALIA
Natalia.
Pleasure to meet you, Micheal.

MICHAEL
Pleasure to meet you, Natalia.

They let go of each other's hand.

Natalia picks up her briefcase and leaves.

Micheal attentively observes her every step.

INT. CHIANTI SUITE - LATER

Maple wood furniture melts over the fine egg white walls of the spacious "Chianti 2019" suite.

The sound of the water running in the bathroom hovers the room, then stops.

The shower doors are slid apart.

Micheal sighs.

Micheal's slippers squelch across the tiles as he comes out of the bathroom wearing a grey bathrobe.

He sits on the bed and turns on the TV.

There is a woman named Marlene giving a reality show confessional.

MARLENE
My name is Marlene Debouis. I work in business, I trade against foreign currencies, against the dollar.

Cut.

MARLENE (CONT'D)
Recently I have taken up karate. I am a green belt.

Cut.

MARLENE (CONT'D)
It's been a healthy way for me to
get out some aggression, you know?

Cut.

MARLENE (CONT'D)
No. I wouldn't say I'm an
aggressive person. I'm really an
easygoing kind of gal. I love a
surprise-
(she considers)
-but I don't like mystery.

Micheal's suite phone rings. He turns off the TV and picks
up.

MICHAEL
Hello?

RECEPTIONIST
Mr. Sherwood?

MICHAEL
Yes?

RECEPTIONIST
There's a woman at reception asking
to see you.

MICHAEL
A woman?

RECEPTIONIST
Yes sir.

MICHAEL
What's her name?

RECEPTIONIST
Sadie. Sadie Miller.

MICHAEL
Oh. Really? Okay. I'll be right
down.

RECEPTIONIST
Wonderful, sir. I'll let her know.

Micheal hangs up the phone.

MICHEAL
Didn't think she would remember.

INT. ELEVATOR - MOMENTS LATER

Micheal, dressed in a nice shirt and black pants, enters the elevator. He presses L.

NATALIA
(as the doors close)
WAIT!

Micheal puts his foot between the doors, stopping them from closing.

The doors reopen on Natalia dressed in gorgeous long green dress.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
Thank you so much.

Natalia steps in the elevator.

The doors close again. The elevator starts descending.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
I knew I was going to see you
again, Micheal.

MICHAEL
You did? I thought so too.

NATALIA
Of course you did.

MICHAEL
How did you know?

NATALIA
'cause I like you Micheal.

She smiles, then checks out his outfit from head to toe.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
You are well dressed.

He replicates her motions.

MICHAEL
You are well dressed.

NATALIA
Oh I know. I am meeting someone
downstairs.

MICHAEL
Me too.

NATALIA
I can tell.

They reach the lobby.

INT. LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

The elevator doors open on a completely empty lobby.

Micheal and Natalia step out of the elevator.

MICHAEL
Where is everybody?

NATALIA
Everybody who?

MICHAEL
The staff? The guests? Anybody?

They turn the corner on the receptionist desk to find there only the **WOMAN IN THE CHECKERED DRESS**.

She is there smiling just like the last time Micheal saw her (RE: scene #1).

Natalia smiles back at her.

NATALIA
There she is.

MICHAEL
You know her?

NATALIA
Since forever.

The woman gestures for them to come to her.

Natalia heads to her, Micheal stays put.

Natalia reaches the woman and lets her head fall on her shoulder as they hug.

The woman keeps her eyes on Micheal, still smiling.

Natalia, tightly wrapped in the woman's arms, turns to him as well.

Micheal tries to move but his legs fail him.

WOMAN
(whispered)
Come here.

INT. CHIANI SUITE - NIGHT

Micheal wakes up fully clothed in bed. His carry-on still closed by his side.

It's dark outside.

Micheal sits up, brings his hands through his hair.

He squints in disgust.

MICHAEL
Jesus fucking Christ.

He stands up.

He struggles to remove his shirt and hoodie as the sweat stuck his skin and the fabric together.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Jesus fucking Christ.

He takes off his pants, which are even more stuck.

As the last foot comes out he delivers a loud retch.

He heads for the bathroom.

We hear the water starting to run.

The TV turns on, seemingly on its own.

Marlene is there again.

MARLENE
My name is Marlene Debouis. I work
in bus-

INT. ELEVATOR - LATER

Micheal, in a T-shirt, jeans and jacket, enters the elevator. He presses L.

As the doors close, a woman's sneaker interposes between them.

The doors reopen, Natalia steps in the elevator, wearing a black suit.

MICHAEL
Hi.

NATALIA
Hi.

Doors close, elevator starts to descend.

MICHAEL
I'm also staying in a Chianti room.

NATALIA
I'm sorry?

MICHAEL
We-

He clears his throat.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
We talked about it before

She looks at him confused. Micheal catches it.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
We met in the-

NATALIA
In the lobby. Earlier this
afternoon. Micheal, right?

MICHAEL
That's right.

NATALIA
You have to forgive me, it's been a
long day.

MICHAEL
I can imagine. With the flight
being canceled and all.

Natalia does not remember giving Micheal this information.

NATALIA
Right.

Awkward silence.

MICHAEL
But yeah- the room is really great.

NATALIA
I'm glad.

The elevator reaches the floor.

Natalia steps out immediately.

MICHAEL
Enjoy your night, Natalia.

She nods with an hint of a smile and takes off.

INT. LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

Micheal steps out of the elevator to see Natalia wiggle through the crowded lobby.

She reaches a man in a **black suit and fedora hat**, who she kisses.

Micheal starts heading out of the hotel.

As he walks, trying to avoid any sort of eye-contact, a person with dwarfism bumps into his leg.

MAN #2
Yo. I'm sorry, I didn't see you.

MICHEAL
It's fine, have a good evening.

Micheal finally reaches the revolving doors and exits.

INT. SADIE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Sadie stands at her window smoking a cigarette, an almost empty glass of red wine and her phone in front of her.

She takes a deep drag, then downs the last sip of wine.

She looks down at her phone, unlocks it.

She goes to the missed phone call from Micheal from earlier.

Her finger lingers over it.

LUCY (O.C.)
Don't.

Sadie turns to Lucy, her visibly younger roommate, standing behind her.

SADIE
Don't what?

LUCY
Don't call him.

SADIE

Him who?

LUCY

(mocking)

Him who?

(normal)

Micheal Sherwood.

SADIE

Oh that's who you meant.

LUCY

Yeah, that's who I meant.

(a beat)

I can give you a hundred- a
thousand reason-

SADIE

Lucy. I'm not going to call him.

LUCY

Good.

Sadie finishes her cigarette.

SADIE

I am very bored though.

LUCY

Then let's go out.

SADIE

You have work in the morning.

LUCY

Fuck it. I'll call in sick. I work
in a goddamn café. Half the staff
is high school students that don't
show up half the time.

SADIE

Half the staff are your peers then.

LUCY

I'm in college now.

SADIE

You have been in college for a
semester.

LUCY
I'm 21 for your information- but
regardless-
Come ooon. We can go to Paddie's.
They are doing all-night-long happy
hour. It's going to be fuuuuun.

Sadie twists her head.

LUCY (CONT'D)
What?

SADIE
All-night-long happy hour?

LUCY
Yes?

SADIE
You know what? You got me there.
Let's go. Fuck it.

LUCY
Awesome! I'm the best.

Lucy hops to her room.

~~Sadie crushes her cigarette.~~

SADIE'S ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Sadie is carefully finishing to put on his lipstick seated
at her desk, when Lucy barges into her room.

SADIE
Yes, Lucy, you can come in.

Lucy smirks ironically.

LUCY
(inquisitive)
You look hot.

SADIE
Thank you?

LUCY
No. Stand up.

SADIE
Give me a sec.

LUCY
You are wearing the skirt aren't
you?

Sadie closes her lipstick, then stands up revealing her jean
skirt.

LUCY (CONT'D)
Of course.

SADIE
What?! It's a cute skirt.

LUCY
That Micheal bought you.

SADIE
Am I not allowed to wear a gift
anymore?

LUCY
It's January Sadie, don't play
dumb.

SADIE
Lucy- and I tell you with all the
love in the world- and for the last
time- mind your own business,
please. If I want to wear Mike's
skirt I'll wear his skirt. I'll
sleep with him if I want to, okay?
I'm a grown woman.

LUCY
I am too.

SADIE
Never said you weren't.

LUCY
I'm sorry, Sadie, it's just- after
last time-

SADIE
It's okay. You don't need to worry
about this, truly.

Lucy brings her eyes to the floor.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Hey.
What did you swat in for?

LUCY
Uber will be here in two minutes.

SADIE
Great.

LUCY
Sadie...

Sadie gets closer to Lucy.

SADIE
Lucy.

Sadie gives her a kiss on the cheek.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Let's go have some fun.

Lucy smiles.

EXT. PADDIE'S PUB - NIGHT

There is a line of college students waiting to get in.

Sadie and Lucy take their place at the back.

Sadie is visibly shivering.

LUCY
Do you want to go somewhere else?

SADIE
No! Why?

LUCY
So you don't freeze to death?

SADIE
I'm not that cold.

Lucy points at the goosebumps on Sadie's legs.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Wait.

LUCY
What?

Sadie is looking ahead in the line.

SADIE
There's no way.

LUCY
Who's there?

SADIE
MARLENE! MARLENE!

A few feet ahead of them there's two women in their fifties,
a brunette and a blonde who is smoking a cigarette.

The brunette turns to Lucy and Sadie.

MARLENE
SADIE! OH MY GOD!

LUCY
Who's that?

SADIE
That's my fucking karate
instructor.

LUCY
What? She's like sixty.

SADIE
I know!

MARLENE
COME HERE!

SADIE
Let's go.

Sadie and Lucy apologetically cut through the protest of the
people ahead to reach Marlene and her friend.

Sadie and Marlene hug tightly.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Oh my God it's so nice to see you.
This is my friend Lucy.

Lucy and Marlene shake hands.

LUCY
Nice to meet you, Marlene.

MARLENE
You are so young Lucy! You are a
baby! What are you doing with this
child, Sadie? Are you leading her
astray?

SADIE
Of course not! She is my roommate.

MARLENE
Oh fun! Roommies outing!

Marlene realizes she hasn't introduced her friend yet.

MARLENE (CONT'D)
Where's my head?!

She palms her forehead.

MARLENE (CONT'D)
This is my best friend!

RHONDA
My name is Rhonny! Well, it's
Rhonda, but don't call me that
unless you are mad at me!

Rhonda and Marlene GUFFAW with delight.

LUCY
Nice to meet you, Rhonda.

RHONDA
Rhonny.

Rhonda loudly laughs again.

SADIE
Pleasure to meet you, Rhonny.

RHONDA
My pleasure!

Again, Rhonda laughs.

The line proceeds ahead.

SADIE
So- what brings you here girls?

Marlene pops her eyes pointing at the neon sign above the entrance.

RHONDA
We are *fun*! We like to dance!

In that moment, Micheal walks right by them.

Sadie instinctively grabs his arm.

SADIE

Mike.

He turns to her, a certain vacuity in his eyes.

MICHAEL

Sadie.

SADIE

Micheal.

MICHAEL

What are you doing here?

He notices the other three women.

LUCY

Hello Micheal.

MICHAEL

Hi, Lucy.

MARLENE

Oh this is Micheal.

RHONDA

I'm Rhonny!

Micheal stops on Marlene.

MICHEAL

Have we met before?

MARLENE

I don't- I don't think so.

MICHEAL

What's your name?

SADIE

Mike.

MARLENE

I'm Marlene.

SADIE

She is my karate instructor.

MICHEAL

What?

SADIE

You know about the karate.

MICHAEL
Yeah. No. Of course.
(a beat)
Can I talk to you for a second?

SADIE
Why?

MICHAEL
Can we talk in private?

SADIE
Nope.

Micheal looks around, thinking.

MICHAEL
Are you going inside?

RHONDA
Of course!

MARLENE
Yeah!

SADIE
Are you not?

MICHAEL
I was leaving actually.

LUCY
Already?

MICHAEL
Yeah. I don't- Can I come by later?

RHONDA
Spicyyy.

SAIDE
What for?

The line keeps going, Micheal walks along it.

MICHEAL
I haven't been completely honest
with you as to why I'm here. There
is a story.

LUCY
Typical.

MICHEAL
Lucy?

LUCY
Micheal.

SADIE
Of course there's a story.

They reach the entrance.

MICHAEL
Saide.

SADIE
I don't know. I don't think so,
Mike.

The girls slip into Paddie's.

Marlene and Rhonda woo loudly.

Micheal lingers at the entrance as Sadie disappears inside.

BODYGUARD
You going back in?

MICHAEL
Ehm- no. No I'm not.

BODYGUARD
Then get the fuck out of my line.

MICHAEL
Oh yeah. Of course.

POV: A CAR PARKED ACROSS THE STREET

We see Micheal scratching his head as he walks away from the bar.

INT. CAR - SAME TIME

From behind their heads, we see NATALIA and The Man In The Fedora Hat closely observing Micheal.

NATALIA
What do you think?

He doesn't reply.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
I think he knows.

The man nods.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
Fuck.

The man nods once again.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
Now?

The man shakes his head.

NATALIA (CONT'D)
What are we waiting for? It's gonna
explode in our hands again.

The man solemnly turns to Natalia.

She gulps. Slowly turns to him.

FEDORA HAT
(deep voice)
Drive.

Natalia frantically nods.

NATALIA
Yes sir.

INT. BAR - EARLIER, MAYBE

Micheal walks into the pub where he is welcomed by warm red lights and ambiance music with very loud bass.

There is almost no one inside.

He gives a nod to the bartender who is cleaning the bar.

MICHAEL
Hey Charlie.

Charlie waves back at him, then robotically moves back to scrubbing the counter.

Micheal keeps walking, he is clearly been here before.

He turns left after the bar, entering a seating area.

In the room there is only a woman with red head, who is sitting right in front of him.

The woman takes a small sip from the beer bottle sitting in front of her.

Micheal proceed to her table, once he reaches her he takes out the chair right in front of her and sits down.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Hello, Red.

RED
Hello, Micheal. It's been a while.

MICHAEL
Feels like it.

RED
Drink?

MICHAEL
Sure.

She signals behind him.

Micheal takes a sit.

Moments later Charlie appears with an open beers and rests it on the table.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Thanks Charlie.

Charlie nods and bolts away.

RED
So what's the bad news?

MICHAEL
Just don't shoot the messenger.

RED
Depends on the news.

The background music EXPLODES in a loud CONTINUATIVE bass, then stops completely.

MICHAEL
Wilson is dead.

RED
No he's not.

The red lights leave space to a more appropriate warm light.

RED (CONT'D)
Is this some sort of joke?

MICHAEL

It's really not, Red. I wish I
wasn't the one to tell you.

RED

When would he have died?

MICHAEL

Last night. Suicide.

She scoffs.

RED

That's funny.

MICHAEL

Red, I'm not kidding.

RED

Mike. I *just* talked to him. He
called me a couple of hours ago,
telling me he found a bunch of
pictures of me and him from college
in his basement. He wanted to know
if I'd take some of them.

MICHAEL

What the hell are you talking
about?

RED

What the hell are you talking
about? This is not funny at all.

Red takes out her phone then drops it on the table on
speakerphone.

It rings. And rings. And rings. And rings, until Michael
almost involuntarily hints at smirk.

WILSON

Hello?

Micheal jumps to his feet. Red points at the phone.

RED

Will?

WILSON

Yeah.

RED

Shit, I meant to call Winston.

Wilson laughs over the phone.

WILSON
Of course.

Micheal paces around the room. Takes a swing from the beer.

WOMAN #2
(over Wilson phone)
Senator? The congressman is waiting
for you.

WILSON
Listen Red I gotta go, let me know
about those pictures.

RED
Of course, Senator.

WILSON
That is still so weird.

Micheal sits back down.

RED
Bye bye.

WILSON
Have a good one.

Red hangs up.

RED
He seems pretty alive to me.

MICHAEL
I don't get it.

RED
Who put you up to this? I'm so
confused.

MICHAEL
Put me up to- My editor called me
last night at 3 am, telling me
Wilson had killed himself and to
come talk to you, but to be as
discreet as possible as press would
be formally informed later. That's
who put me up to this.

RED
Maybe he was pulling your leg?

MICHAEL
Pulling my leg?

RED
Fucking with you?

MICHAEL
Yeah I know what that means.

She finishes her beer. He does the same in a single sip.

RED
Prank call?

MICHAEL
(as he opens his phone)
Who would-
(as he moves his finger
over the screen)
-also he called me from his own-

He freezes. His lips part.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
He never called me.

RED
(laughing)
I'm sorry?

MICHAEL
He never fucking called me.

Micheal bolts on his feet and heads out the seating area.

RED
Wait! Micheal!

Micheal turns the corner at the bar.

RED (O.C.) (CONT'D)
Micheal!

Micheal heads for the door, Red follows by the bar.

RED (CONT'D)
(as Micheal opens pushes
the door)
Micheal stop!
(as he exits)
MICHEAL!

EXT. SADIE'S BUILDING - NIGHT

Micheal is shaken awake by Sadie on the concrete stairs to her building. Lucy observes behind her.

SADIE
Micheal!

Micheal slowly opens his red and puffy eyes.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Jesus Christ you are drunk.

MICHEAL
I'm not-

The smell of his own breath makes him RETCH.

LUCY
Jesus.

MICHEAL
When did I drink?

SADIE
Amazing.

Sadie pushes the building door open, which opens on...

SADIE'S ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Sadie drags Micheal in the room.

Micheal stumbles inside and turns to Sadie, who doesn't move from the door frame.

SADIE
Wait here.

MICHAEL
Wait.

Sadie slams the door closed and exits.

Micheal rubs his hands on his face, then looks around the room. He grimaces.

He leans over Sadie's desk to take a look at his own face in her make-up mirror.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
(to himself)
Stupid.

His attention diverts to the objects on the table.

The open script for Mean Girls, Sadie's make-up items, her journal with a little porcelain elephant on top.

He reaches out for the journal and picks up the elephant. He observes it closely, then smiles.

He opens the middle drawer in the desk. It's a stationary drawer. He places the elephant inside and closes it back.

He brings his eyes to the board above the desk. There are pictures and postcards pinned to it.

He scouts it, as if looking for something specific. He snaps his fingers when he sees it.

It's a picture of him and Sadie dressed up as Dick Diggler and Rollergirl from "Boogie Nights".

He instinctively reaches out to it, but by unpinning it, he also unpins the postcard behind it, which falls right in the small gap between the desk and the wall.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Shit.

Micheal leaves the halloween picture on the table and crawls under the table.

He gets to the postcard which is from Jakarta. Micheal is about to turn the postcard to his back when...

SADIE (O.C.)

What *in the actual fuck* are you doing?

Michael crawls backwards from under the desk. He hits his head on the table getting back up, knocking down some of Sadie's makeup items.

Sadie rolls her eyes.

SADIE (CONT'D)

What do you have there?

MICHAEL

Oh. It fell from the board.

SADIE

Right now?

MICHAEL

Maybe when you slammed the-

Sadie notices the Halloween picture next to Micheal.

SADIE
Why is that next to you?

MICHAEL
What?

SADIE
What- Wha- Wha- Are you a fucking
duck? Why is the Boogie Nights
picture next to you?

MICHAEL
W- I-

He sighs.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
I wanted to take a closer look at
it. I don't have it anywhere.

She walks up next to him, takes the picture.

She takes a good look at it, then twitches her nose. She
slams the picture to his chest.

SADIE
Now you do.

MICHAEL
Sadie.

She walks up to the window and turns her shoulders to
Micheal. She lights a cigarette.

Micheal tries to approach her, but she stops him in his
tracks.

SADIE
Don't.

She takes a deep drag.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Why are you here? Why are you doing
this to me? Is there something I
haven't given you? Do you want all
my sanity? All of my peace of mind?
You were passed out on my fucking
doorsteps. Do you understand how
fucked up is that? You could have
fucking died. Is that why you came
here? **Do** die on me?
(MORE)

SADIE (CONT'D)

You want me to have your death on my hands for the rest of my life?

MICHAEL

How can you even-

SADIE

You have a problem, Micheal. You can deny it, but you do. You always did. But ever since your father died- Jesus. I don't want to judge. I don't even want to say it. I'm sorry. But you do. And I won't- I can't just stand idly by while you turn into whatever you are becoming. I can't just pretend that this is any way, shape or form okay, or even normal. This is fucked up. Because you are completely fucked.

MICHAEL

You still talk to my mum, don't you?

SADIE

I do, Mike. She is really worried. I am too.

Sadie finishes her cigarette.

MICHAEL

Can I have one?

SADIE

Sure.

Sadie leaves cigarettes and lighter next to window. Micheal leaves the Boogie Nights picture on the desk.

They silently switch places.

Micheal takes place by the window and observes Sadie looking down at the picture. A tear slowly dripping down her cheek.

Micheal clears his voice.

MICHAEL

You are right. It has not been great. It's been bad, actually. Really bad. I don't know if it's the drinking or what, but I just have this like- holes.

(MORE)

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

I forget things and I remember other things that I'm not even sure ever happened. I don't- I genuinely don't know how I ended up on your doorsteps. I remembering leaving Paddy's and then I woke up here. Just like I remember texting you and then I was shaken awake on a train to Boston all fucking confused. I am not trying to die, Sadie and I am surely not trying to cause you anymore pain.

SADIE

But you are.

MICHAEL

I know.

SADIE

I don't think you do.

MICHAEL

Same issue as ever.

SADIE

I guess so.

Sadie looks down at the Boogie Nights picture once more.

SADIE (CONT'D)

(still looking down)

Is Red who you met at Paddie's?

MICHAEL

Why do you ask?

SADIE

She took this picture.

MICHAEL

She did?

SADIE

Oh yeah. You don't remember her costume?

MICHAEL

Wait. Shit.

He laughs.

MICHEAL
What the fuck. What was she
supposed to be?

SADIE
Neytiri from Avatar.

MICHAEL
And she looked like fucking slutty
Smurfette!

They both burst out lighting.

Micheal lights his cigarette.

The laughter dies down.

SADIE
So?

MICHAEL
Yeah. I went to see Red.

SADIE
How come?

MICHAEL
I don't think you want to know.

SADIE
I could use a pinch of honesty from
you, Mike.

MICHAEL
I thought something had happened to
Wilson, so I went to give her the
news.

SADIE
But nothing happened.

MICHAEL
Yeah.

SADIE
That's-

MICHAEL
Yeah.

Sadie huffs, Micheal rises his eyebrows.

Sadie looks down at her skirt.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

I'm going back to Philly tomorrow.
I'm going to figure this all thing
out. I won't- I won't make my life
your problem anymore.

SADIE

Don't do that.

MICHAEL

I'm not doing anything. I'm being
serious. You don't deserve this and
I certainly do not deserve you.

SADIE

Deserve. Nobody deserves anybody.
You know me, Mike. Stop talking to
me like you want to say the right
thing all of a sudden.

He takes a deep drag.

MICHAEL

What do you think?

SADIE

I want to drive you to ReJoice
tomorrow.

MICHAEL

Rehab?

SADIE

It's more than that. You know that.

He smiles and turns to the window.

As he lift his head up, he sees THE WOMAN IN THE CHECKERED
DRESS sitting on the balcony in front of him.

He jumps back terrified.

SADIE (CONT'D)

What?!

Sadie runs to the window where she sees no one.

MICHAEL

ReJoice?

She nods.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

First thing in the morning?

She nods.

Tears run up to the eyes of the both of them.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
(whispered)
Thank you.

She wipes tears away and walks to the door.

She turns to him and looks at him right in the eye.

She tries to say something, but the words die on the tip of tongue.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
I like your skirt.

SADIE
(breaking)
Good night, Mike.

She exits.

90'S COMMERCIAL

OFFICE

A blonde woman sits behind a desk, her back facing the camera. She is sitting in front of an open window above an immense garden.

She twirls her chair to face the camera, a large smile on her face.

SARAH
Hello. I'm Sarah Burgundy. Managing Director and Founder of ReJoice Recommitment Center. When I started this project, over a decade ago, I had a clear vision in mind. A North Star guiding my every step ever since. I wanted to create a space where every men and women could face their own inhibitions- were those to be physical, mental or emotional- and ultimately *reaffirm their commitment to life*. To be alive and grateful for everyday.

STAPLES

Sarah is petting a brown horse.

SARAH

At ReJoice we believe that no motivation is ever strong enough if it is not originated deep within our own selves. Whether your struggle is internal or coming from external occurrences, the climb starts with identifying who you are and what you want at the deep center of your core.

ART ROOM

Sarah sits on a stool, her back to an empty canvas.

SARAH

As opposed to more conventional therapy methods, the Rejoice Paradigm poises self-expression and self-determination as its absolute cornerstones. We can give you every tool in the box, but what we cannot do the work for you.

WHITE SCREEN

MAN #3

At ReJoice I found the courage to leave the cult.

WOMAN #3

At ReJoice I overcame bulimia.

MAN #4

At the ReJoice I learned to forgive my abusers.

WOMAN #4

At ReJoice I defeated my sociopathic tendencies.

EXT. REJOICE COMPOUND - DAY

Sarah stands in front of Rejoice's staff members, who wear purple scrubs.

SARAH

What are you waiting for? Your path back to joy starts right here: at ReJoice.

As the camera pushes away:

VOICEOVER
(really fats)
ReJoice is not a medical center. No
promise of complete recovery from
physical or mental conditions
should be inferred from this
commercial.

INT. CAR - DAY

Sadie is driving, Micheal sits in the passenger seat.

Micheal stops the ad on his phone.

MICHEAL
Is this really the last commercial
they ran?

SADIE
Your mum says it didn't perform
great.

MICHEAL
Well, no shit.

SADIE
Maybe you can write them a new one
while you are there.

MICHEAL
Maybe you can even star in it.

SADIE
Finally. The break out role I was
so disparately looking for.

MICHEAL
You are very welcome.

Micheal looks out the window as they drive past the Boston
sign.

"Chelsea Morning" by Joni Mitchell starts playing at low
volume from the car stereo.

Sadie taps rhythmically on the wheel. Michael hums it
softly.

Sadie starts singing the lyrics, as she does, Micheal ups
the volume and joins in.

EXT. ROAD - SAME TIME

Sadie's car drives by as the Sadie and Micheal sing.

CAMERA stays on the diner by the road. We zoom in on one of the window, where Natalia and the Man In The Fedora Hat sit next to each other, observing the direction where the car drove.

We stay on them from outside the window, as the song continues Natalia speaks but we can't hear her. The Man is impassive.

Finally as the song runs to its end, The Man turns to Natalia and shakes his head.

INT. DINER - LATER

Coffee, orange juice, an egg and cheese sandwich and an English breakfast slam on the table.

WAITER
Enjoy your breakfast.

SADIE
Thank you very much.

The waiter leaves, Sadie and Micheal dig into their breakfast.

Sadie looks at him, but he is eating.

Then he does the same, but misses her.

Sadie looks up at him again, Micheal spies up without turning his head. Noticing she is looking at her, he looks back down at his plate.

SADIE (CONT'D)
Micheal.

MICHAEL
Yes Sadie.

SADIE
About last night-

MICHAEL
We don't have to.

SADIE
But we should.

MICHAEL
Maybe- but we truly don't have to.
It's done. We are going. We have
what? Two hours 'till we are there?
(MORE)

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Can we just- you know- have a good
time while we still have time?

She takes deep breath.

SADIE

Sure.

Micheal raises his coffee cup.

MICHAEL

Cheers.

SADIE

Cheers.

They join their cups, bang them on the table and then drink.